James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Marketer who has built marketing functions from scratch as the first or only marketer at SaaS, fintech and technical B2B companies across Africa, North America and Europe. I own positioning, search, AI answer visibility, paid and lifecycle, and I write and ship the work myself. My search and answer-engine work includes a 3,000-keyword organic build at Distrobird, a multi-market AI answer teardown for Binance, and a public audit tool that measures which sources AI assistants cite. I have hired and run writers, editors and specialists, and I report spend against real pipeline. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/klarent.

Selected Achievements:

- Built Distrobird's inbound engine as Head of Inbound Marketing and SEO: ranked for **3,000+ competitive keywords in three months** and reached **500K monthly search impressions**, running five writers and two editors.
- Took Reform from a general form builder to a conversion-focused product. **34% lift in trial activation**, **48% rise in non-branded organic traffic** from an AI-assisted SEO engine that scaled output to 100 articles a month, and **19% more decision-stage leads** from competitor pages.
- Built a technical robotics company's marketing from one indexed page: **1 to 17 indexed pages and a 2,064% rise in organic sessions in nine weeks**, plus positioning, 15 landing pages and Google and LinkedIn Ads setup.
- Ran AI answer audits on four companies and published them, including a **30-question audit of Klarent** across ChatGPT (through OpenAI's Codex), Perplexity, Gemini and Google AI Overviews (Klarent was named in **none of the answers to the 18 questions that leave its name out**), a six-market, four-language Binance teardown and an open-source audit tool that asks AI models the questions buyers ask and records who gets cited.
- Generated **1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months** as Head of Growth and Marketing at Bujeti (YC W23), with 200+ coming from events and partnerships and new B2B customers up **500%** in Q1 2024.

KEY SKILLS

Strategy: Positioning & Messaging, Go-to-Market & Launch Planning, Founding-Hire Marketing Function Build, Competitive Positioning, Content Strategy, Channel Mix & Budget Allocation, Pipeline Reporting

Execution: SEO & Technical SEO, AI Search & Answer Engine Optimization (AEO and GEO), LinkedIn & Google Ads, Founder-Voice Social Content, Webinars & Events, Lifecycle Email, Landing Pages & CRO, Writer & Agency Management

Tools: Google Search Console & GA4 APIs, Ahrefs, DataForSEO, Looker Studio, Google Tag Manager, HubSpot, Webflow, Claude Code, n8n, Python

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 – Present
Marketing In Action (newsletter, academy and marketing services, Nigeria, US, UK)

- Grew the newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers across 86 countries at a 47% average open rate, through SEO, webinars and newsletter partnerships, and run the sponsorship program end to end.
- Co-host Marketing & Chill twice a year in Lagos for 60 to 80 marketers, founders and creators.
- Built and published a 52-step SEO, GEO and AEO audit playbook, and ran it on my own consumer site: an audit through the Search Console, URL Inspection and GA4 APIs found 34 of 60 pages unknown to Google, and a weekly scheduled job now tracks the fixes.
- Built a paid-acquisition system across seven ad platforms that judges campaigns on backend sales. It caught Meta cross-crediting sales between products and isolated a checkout drop-off that ad data had blamed on creative.
- Run a paid-ads services business with three specialists delivering client work through a documented handoff and reporting system.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
Reform (SaaS, conversion-focused form builder, acquired by FunnelEnvy)

- Repositioned the product around lead conversion: 34% lift in trial activation and 19% more decision-stage leads from competitor pages.
- Built an AI-assisted SEO engine and integration pages for HubSpot, Zapier, Typeform and Jotform: 48% rise in non-branded organic traffic, 28% more organic sessions from integration pages and a 22% domain rating gain.
- Launched the Pro Plan Free Trial: 21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion. Built the Feature Launch Plan Framework: 26% lift in new feature adoption within 90 days.
- Built Reform's partner program on PartnerStack from scratch: recruiting, incentives, tracking and swipe assets.

GTM Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
FunnelEnvy (B2B, revenue funnel optimization service provider)

- Built a quarterly demand generation roadmap across outbound, lifecycle and paid: 40% quarter-over-quarter lift in qualified enterprise leads.

- Planned and hosted FunnelEnvy's first webinar: 41 registrations, 29% attendance and 39 new newsletter subscribers. Launched the newsletter at a 48% average open rate.
- Ran an outbound and account-based program: 31% lift in enterprise meeting bookings and 27% higher reply rates.
- Led the FunnelEnvy rebrand and ran an outsourced content agency.

GTM Consultant | Hank Robotics | Aug 2025 – Nov 2025
Hank Robotics (B2B, AI-powered drone and robotics systems)

- Built positioning, messaging and an ICP from scratch for a company with no marketing function and one indexed page.
- Built the SEO content architecture (service, industry, persona and case study pages), deployed 15 landing pages and set up Google and LinkedIn Ads for property managers and facility owners.
- Within 90 days: MQLs up 1,900%, Google Search clicks up 267% and impressions up 111%.

GTM & Product Marketing Consultant | Komfot Health | Nov 2025 – Mar 2026
Komfot Health (B2C and B2B2C digital health, Nigeria, Rwanda, Benin)

- Defined the go-to-market structure for three countries and adapted positioning and messaging to legal and cultural limits in each market.
- Audited seven acquisition channels and built the partnership framework for lead flow.

Head of Inbound Marketing & SEO | Distrobird | Feb 2024 – Apr 2024
Distrobird (sales engagement SaaS, US)

- Owned inbound goals and growth experiments across SEO, content, community and events.
- Led five writers and two editors: ranked for 3,000+ competitive keywords in three months, 500K monthly impressions, 5,000 organic clicks in 90 days and 4x content output.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024
Bujeti (YC W23, SaaS, fintech spend and expense management, Nigeria)

- Built the growth function across product marketing, lifecycle, SEO, events and partnerships.
- Generated 1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months, with 200+ from events and partnerships, and grew new B2B customers 500% in Q1 2024.
- Improved landing page conversion 20% and product conversion 18%. Redesigned lifecycle flows: 20% higher engagement and 10% lower churn.

Chief Revenue Officer | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023
Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B technology and training provider, UK and Sub-Saharan Africa)

- Progressed from Sales Manager to Head of Growth & Marketing to Chief Revenue Officer, running revenue operations and cross-functional go-to-market teams.

- Launched the CIL Academy across Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Rwanda and Angola: 20,000+ community members and 10,000+ users in the first cohort at under $0.50 customer acquisition cost. Keynoted the CIL and AWS Lagos Executive Cloud Technology Summit in 2023.
- Generated 1,646 marketing qualified leads, 406 sales qualified leads and 629 demos: $326K in sales velocity and $3.4M in open deal value.
- Ran paid campaigns at 2-3x return on ad spend on $1.5K to $15K monthly budgets.

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022
B2B, SaaS, fintech, consumer brands and service businesses

- Product Marketing Manager at Bento Africa (payroll and HR fintech across Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya and Rwanda): 50% more sales qualified leads and 25% higher sales conversion from lead scoring and lifecycle nurture programs.
- Marketing & Growth Advisor at JegzFits Leatherworks (consumer brand, Nigeria, 2021 to present): Meta and TikTok acquisition held at about 8x return on ad spend as spend grew.

SELECTED PUBLIC WORK

- **AI answer audits, published:** Klarent (30 questions a QA or engineering lead would type, run through ChatGPT (through OpenAI's Codex), Perplexity, Gemini and Google AI Overviews on 16 October 2026, with a ranked fix list; jamespraise.xyz/work/klarent/proof), Binance (12 searches across Nigeria, Kenya, South Africa, Ghana, Cameroon and Côte d'Ivoire in four languages, plus a Perplexity check, with a 90-day plan), Arcessio (open-source Python audit that found AI crawlers could read fewer than 25 words on 14 of 15 pages) and Openbenchmarks (36 buyer searches plus a charted benchmark article). github.com/realjaymes/ai-answer-visibility-audit
- **SEO, GEO & AEO Playbook:** 52-step audit that scores a site on technical foundations, content, authority and AI visibility. marketinginaction.xyz/resources/seo-geo-aeo-playbook
- **Marketing Agent Skills for Claude Code:** 81 skills built and used daily, 32 published on GitHub. github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills

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EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
- **Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification** | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- **Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification** | Clay (2025)
- **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0